# Session 1 Presentation

for Tales of Defiance to Mind Control in the Modern Age

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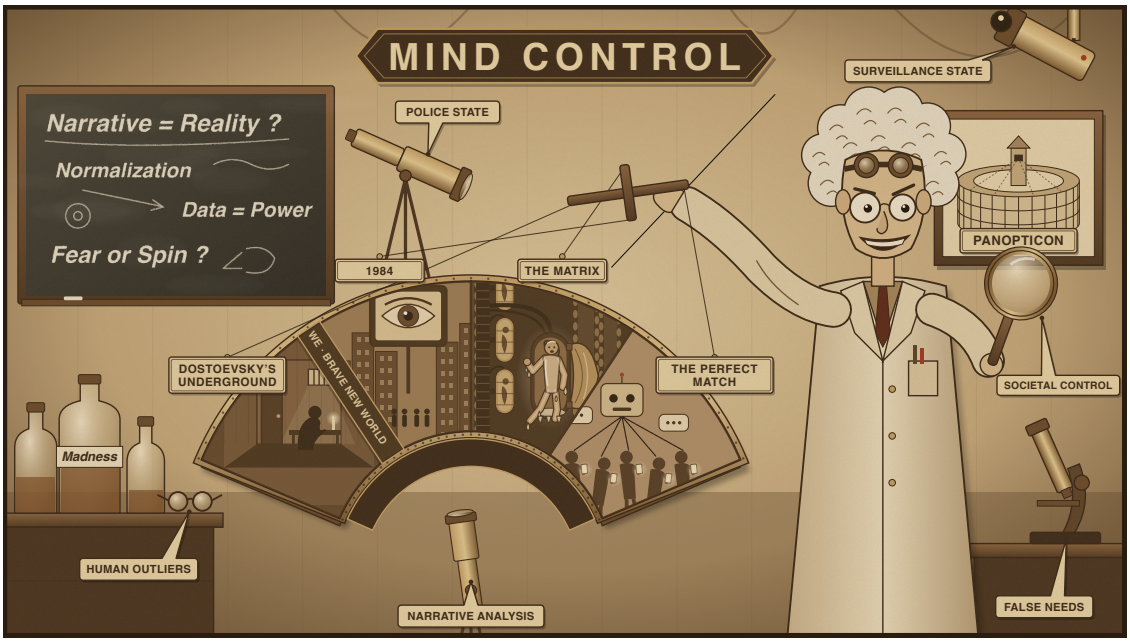
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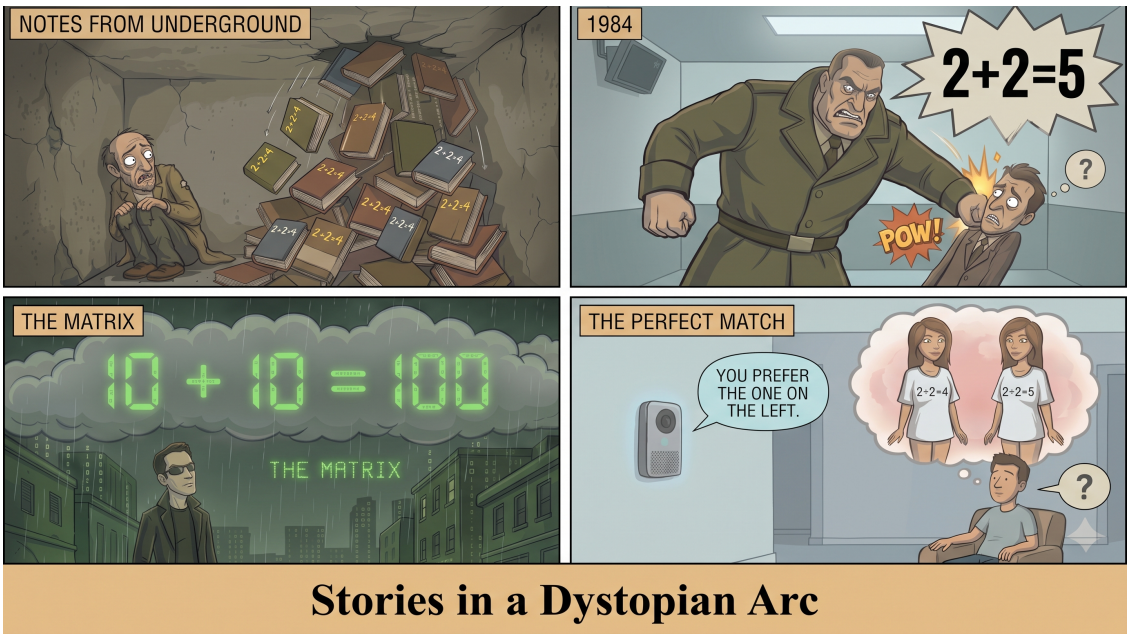
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## Course Overview:



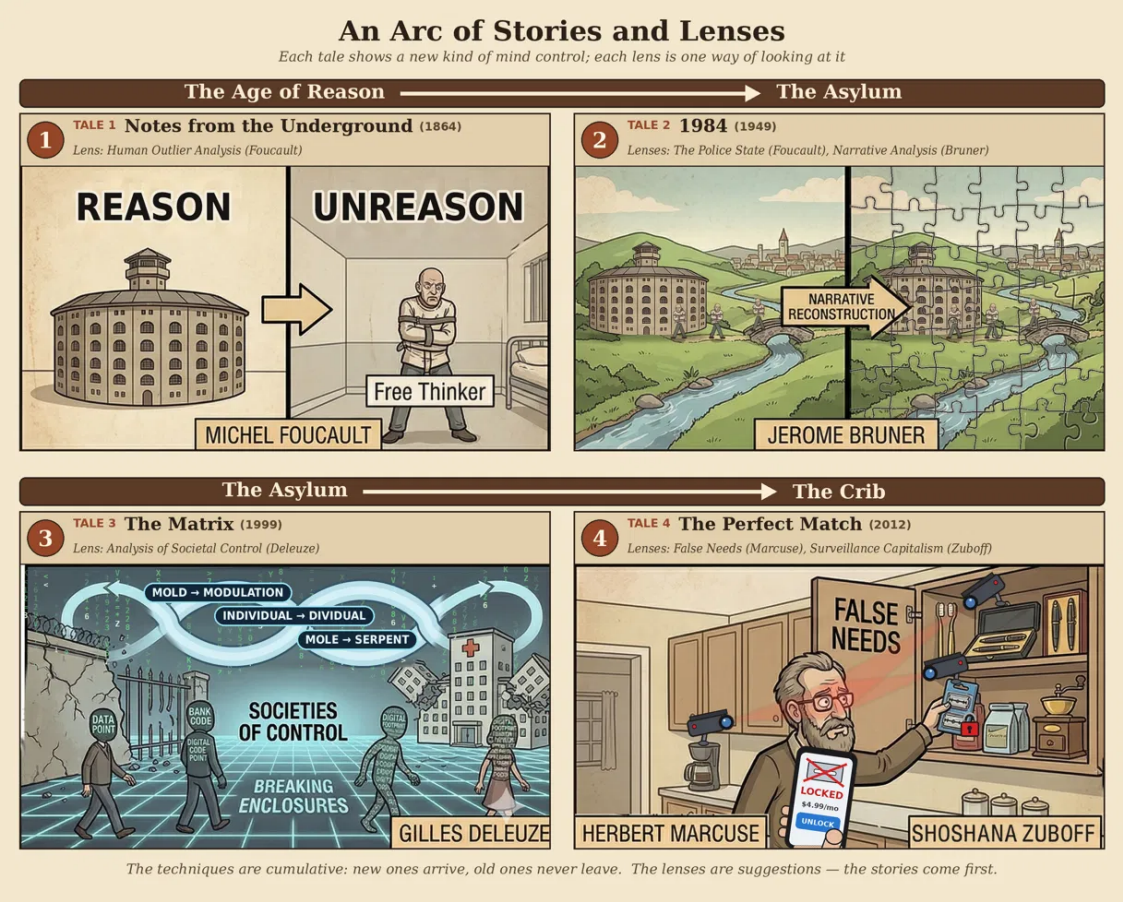

- Look at modern age stories where societies impose/offer mind control.
- Consider characters who are rebelling.
- Ask questions through various lenses.

## Stories in a Dystopian Arc




- Dostoyevsky's Underground Man, isolated and being crushed by 2+2=4 reason .
- Winston from "1984" being pounded by Big Brother to truly believe 2+2=5.
- Neo from "The Matrix" perceiving that his entire world is a computer simulation, seeing the simulation of 2+2=4 in binary.
- Sai from "The Perfect Match" being nudged by the AI agent Tilly to tell him that he prefers the beautiful girl in the "2+2=4" T-shirt.

## Some Lenses




- **Michel Foucault:**
  - Civilization constraining madness.
  - The panopticon (prison) of thought.
  - Disciplinary surveillance.
  - Postmodernism.
- **Jerome Bruner:** Narrative Analysis
- **Gilles Deluze:**
  - Foucault's "enclosures" (prisons, schools, hospitals) are breaking down.
  - We are no longer "individuals" in a room; we are "dividuals"—data points, bank codes, and digital footprints that are tracked in an open, continuous loop of control.
  - It's not about being locked in a cage; it's about being part of a network where the "control" is fluid and constant.
- **Herbert Marcuse:** Control through false needs.
- **Soshanna Zuboff:** Surveillance Capitalism